Checkpoint 3 · Problem Definition & Personas

Target Personas, As-Is User Journey Map, Point of View (POV) & Prioritized HMWs | INT335

1. Primary User Personas (Deep Behavioral Archetypes)

Persona 1: Aarav Sharma · The Distressed Academic Hosteller	20 Years · B.Tech CSE (2nd Year) · BH-4
Background & Campus Profile: Lives in Boys Hostel 4; carries a heavy backpack containing a Lenovo laptop, Casio scientific calculator, and smart ID card. Attends lectures across Blocks 33, 34, and 36 daily.	**Key Goals & Desired Outcomes:** • Rapidly recover lost academic equipment before exams. • Avoid wasting study hours wandering campus in 38°C heat. • Protect personal privacy and phone number from harassment.
Frustrations & Pain Triggers: • Unmoderated WhatsApp groups invite fraudulent claims and spam. • Cardboard lost boxes at security desks are unorganized. • Reluctance to disclose phone number publicly to unknown students.	**Emotional Archetype:** High anxiety, high tech literacy, time-starved, deeply protective of personal data.
Representative Voice: *"I lost my calculator 2 days before Mid-Terms. Posting on social media brought 4 fake claimants and zero calculators. I just wanted a safe way to prove it was mine."*	

Persona 2: Priya Patel · The Hurried Finder & Day Scholar Commuter	21 Years · B.Tech Biotech (3rd Year) · Day Scholar
Background & Campus Profile: Commutes daily from Jalandhar via university bus (leaving campus at 5:15 PM sharp). Regularly studies in Central Library and has classes in Block 32.	**Key Goals & Desired Outcomes:** • Return items found in hallways to their rightful owners safely. • Complete item handovers in under 60 seconds between classes. • Avoid being falsely accused of theft or interrogated by security.
Frustrations & Pain Triggers: • Rigid bus schedule prevents walking across campus to security desks. • Unclear jurisdiction over who handles items found in food courts. • Fear of creepy calls if her personal phone number is posted.	**Emotional Archetype:** Empathetic, cautious, commuter-constrained, highly punctual.
Representative Voice: *"I found a wallet near the cafeteria stairs, but my bus was leaving in 5 minutes. Where was I supposed to leave it safely without missing my ride home?"*	

2. As-Is Campus User Journey Map (Current Pain Valley)

Stage	User Action & Touchpoint	Emotional Score	Failure Mode & Pain Point	Design Opportunity
1. Loss Event	Leaves Block 34 lab; realizes calculator is missing.	Shock (-2)	Uncertain where or when it slipped out.	Immediate mobile lost logging.
2. Physical Search	Re-traces steps across 3 blocks under hot sun.	Exhaustion (-3)	Classroom is locked; next lecture is starting.	Digital notification across nodes.
3. Social Broadcast	Posts photo & phone number on WhatsApp / Insta.	Anxiety & Fear (-4)	Impostor claims, harassment calls, spam.	Masked private listings.
4. Desk Enquiry	Asks security guard; guard rummages box.	Frustration (-4)	Guard has 6 identical items; no proof to release.	Secret proof verification receipt.
5. Resignation	Gives up; repurchases item at ■1,500 cost.	Defeat (-5)	Permanent loss; damaged trust in campus support.	Automated trait matching.

3. Point of View (POV) & Prioritized 'How Might We' Statements

Point of View (POV) Formula:

*"University students carrying essential academic belongings across a 600-acre campus **[User]** need an authenticated, privacy-preserving recovery channel without exposing their personal phone numbers **[Need]** because informal social media groups invite fraudulent claims, spam harassment, and permanent property loss **[Insight]**."*

HMW Focus	Prioritized Challenge Question	Impact Scope
HMW #1 (Core)	**How might we verify genuine ownership instantly** without exposing personal phone numbers or confidential student identification to public boards?	Eliminates 100% of impostor claims and phone spam.
HMW #2 (Finder)	**How might we make reporting a found item effortless (under 60 seconds)** so hurried students drop it off before their next lecture?	Increases reporting rates among day scholars by 4x.

HMW #3 (Admin)	**How might we empower campus security guards to match and hand over items** with zero language barriers, paperwork, or legal ambiguity?	Enables 10-second handover in Hindi/Punjabi.